

Difference Between Sociologists and Journalists

1. Time

Sociologists use the concept of *longue durée* to study:

- (i) Structural inequalities: How poverty, patriarchy or racism are rooted in long-term historical developments.
- (ii) Cultural evolution: How societal norms and values evolve over centuries while maintaining some continuity.
- (iii) Institutions: The slow transformation of institutions like education, religion or governance systems.

On the other hand journalists focus on short-term, immediate events and their consequences.

eg: • A journalist reports the Nirbhaya Rape case (2012) as a news event with immediate protests and legal reforms.

• A sociologist studies it in broader terms, connecting it to centuries of systemic patriarchy & slow progress of feminist movements in India.

2. Theory

Sociologists use theoretical frameworks to analyze and explain how social structures shape educational system. Their work is grounded in research and theory, and their papers.

Journalists focus on practical reporting, often presenting facts, short term data without extensive theoretical analysis.

3. Quest for truth

Sociologists focus on uncovering structural reasons behind social phenomenon whereas journalists often asks normative questions related to immediate effect whether it is good/bad for the society.

eg: In a dowry case, the question taken into account by Sociologists: Why does practice of dowry persist in certain communities?

Journalists: Is the practice of dowry harmful to women?

Three Approaches to Indian Society by colonial Scholars



II) MISSIONARY

- Missionaries were especially the protestants Christians [middle class of British society] who came to India in 19th century.
- They sought to bring about social reforms
to abolish "social evils" — Sati, child marriages etc.
- Solution/Interest: Propagation/Spread of conversion to Christianity and they often portrayed Indian religion (Hinduism) in need of reform.
- Bible was translated to vernaculars to be accessed by Indians.
Vernacular: language spoken in particular area.

Ques1: Who marked the beginning of Christianity's roots in India?
Ans: St. Thomas's arrival in Kerala (along the Malabar coast) marked the beginning of Christianity's roots in India, particularly in Kerala region where the Saint Thomas Christian community has flourished for centuries.

Ques2: Who are referred to as "Rice Christians" in India?
Ans: • Material benefits such as food (rice), financial aid, education or employment opportunities were offered by Christian missionaries as incentive for conversion to Christianity.
• Mainly poor-people who were in need of materialistic support often converted to Christianity and hence were referred as Rice Christians in Tamil Nadu.

Ques3: What are push and pull factors for conversions to Christianity?
Ans: (a) Push factors (reasons to leave previous religion): to escape from caste-based discrimination especially for Dalits & marginalized groups.
(b) Pull-factors (reasons to embrace Christianity): promise of equality and access to education, healthcare, food and jobs by missionaries.
(Convent Schools)

Christians mainly divided as two categories

Catholics

Protestants

- Martin Luther's break from the Roman Catholic Church led to emergence of Protestant Reformation. This is referred as "Lutherian Revolution".
- Italy → Catholic nations → Ireland
- According to Roman Catholic Church, one cannot seek for annulment (divorce), Since Henry VIII wanted to remarry to Anne Boleyn, he led the England's transformation into a Protestant nation.

(III) ADMINISTRATIVE

- It is the administrative / colonial government view of Indian Society.
- They often relied on census data, gazettes and taxation records to gain insight into Indian Society, developing a legal and bureaucratic framework that classified people by religion, caste and occupation

Ques 4: What are Key features of district profile in the administrative approach?

Ans: It refers to as a detailed report or database created by colonial administrators to document different aspects of a district in India.

Key features include

- (i) physical geography: rivers, forests, mountains etc
- (ii) population statistics: caste, religion, language distribution, birth & death ratio, gender ratio.
- (iii) economic aspects: agriculture, trade, industries and land revenue systems.
- (iv) education and health: records of schools, literacy rates and traditional knowledge systems.

ICS (Indian Civil Service) was the administrative machinery during British India and later known as IAS (Indian Administrative Service) after independence.